

CeraVe Hydrating Cleanser

Positioning: 🏆 Gentle hydrating cleanser for normal-to-dry and sensitive skin — with ceramides + hyaluronic acid

For Skinwise, this is one of the products I would consider a **core/basic cleanser**, because it focuses on the most important job of a cleanser: **effective cleansing without leaving the skin feeling stripped or tight**. CeraVe officially positions it for normal-to-dry skin.

SKINWISE QUICK TAGS

Gentle • Hydrating • Barrier Support • Ceramides • Hyaluronic Acid • Fragrance-Free • Non-Comedogenic • Normal-to-Dry

★ WHY SKINWISE SELECTED IT

The strength of this cleanser is **not a long list of trendy actives**.

It has a relatively straightforward philosophy:

Gentle cleansing + hydration support + skin-barrier support

The current official formula contains **three ceramides (NP, AP, EOP), hyaluronic acid, glycerin, cholesterol and phytosphingosine**.

CeraVe also states that it is **non-comedogenic, free of added fragrance**, and accepted by the National Eczema Association.

BEST FOR

● Excellent choice for:

- **Dry skin**
- **Normal-to-dry skin**
- Sensitive skin
- Dehydrated skin
- Skin that feels tight after cleansing
- People using potentially drying skincare treatments

● Can also work for:

- Normal skin
- Combination skin, particularly if the cheeks are dry

CeraVe itself notes that the cleanser can work across skin types, although its primary positioning is **normal-to-dry**.



MAY NOT BE THE FIRST CHOICE FOR

Very oily skin

If someone says:

“My face gets very oily and I want a fresh foaming cleanse.”

I'd consider **CeraVe Foaming Facial Cleanser** instead.

CeraVe specifically positions that cleanser for **normal-to-oily skin** and oil control.

Very congested/acne-prone skin

If the main concern is **comedones/oily congestion**, a targeted cleanser such as a salicylic-acid cleanser may make more sense than choosing Hydrating Cleanser specifically for acne.



KEY INGREDIENTS



Ceramides NP + AP + EOP

These are the star ingredients.

They are skin-identical/skin-related barrier lipids and are included to support the skin's protective barrier.



Glycerin

A humectant that supports hydration and helps make cleansing more comfortable.



Hyaluronic Acid

Present as **sodium hyaluronate** in the published ingredient list.

Supports moisture balance.



Cholesterol + Phytosphingosine

These complement the barrier-lipid approach of the formula.



Fatty alcohols

Cetearyl alcohol, stearyl alcohol and cetyl alcohol are present.

Important Skinwise point:

These are fatty alcohols, not the same thing as drying ethanol/alcohol.

They mainly contribute to the creamy/emollient formulation.



CURRENT PUBLISHED INGREDIENT LIST

Aqua/Water, Glycerin, Cetearyl Alcohol, PEG-40 Stearate, Stearyl Alcohol, Potassium Phosphate, Ceramide NP, Ceramide AP, Ceramide EOP, Carbomer, Glyceryl Stearate, Behentrimonium Methosulfate, Sodium Lauroyl Lactylate, Sodium Hyaluronate, Cholesterol, Phenoxyethanol, Disodium EDTA, Dipotassium Phosphate, Tocopherol, Phytosphingosine, Xanthan Gum, Cetyl Alcohol, Polysorbate 20, Ethylhexylglycerin.

Important: CeraVe says formulations can be updated, so Skinwise should verify the ingredient list on the actual Indian pack before publishing it.

✨ TEXTURE & FINISH

Creamy / lotion-like → low-foam → comfortable → non-stripping feel

This is **not** the cleanser to choose if the customer specifically wants a rich foaming sensation.

Its appeal is:

“My skin feels clean but not tight.”



SKINWISE SUITABILITY

Skin Type	Suitability
● Dry	★★★★★
● Normal-to-Dry	★★★★★
● Sensitive	★★★★★
● Normal	★★★★★
● Combination	★★★★

● Oily



● Acne-Prone



The acne-prone score deserves explanation: **non-comedogenic + gentle** makes it a reasonable cleanser for an acne patient, but it doesn't provide an acne-active such as salicylic acid. CeraVe separately offers its Renewing SA Cleanser for acne-prone skin.

PROS

- ★ Excellent for **dry/normal-to-dry skin**
 - ★ Very good sensitive-skin option
 - **Three essential ceramides**
 - **Hyaluronic acid**
 - **Glycerin**
 - Contains cholesterol/phytosphingosine
 - **Fragrance-free**
 - **Non-comedogenic**
 - Doesn't rely on exfoliating acids
 - Good everyday cleanser
 - Barrier-focused formulation
 - Developed with dermatologists
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THINGS TO KNOW

- Not designed primarily for strong oil control.
 - Doesn't contain salicylic acid or benzoyl peroxide.
 - Someone with very oily skin may prefer a foaming cleanser.
 - "Ceramides + HA" shouldn't be interpreted as making this a substitute for a leave-on moisturizer.
 - Exact formula can vary by market and can change over time.
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HOW TO USE

Morning and/or evening

1. Wet face with lukewarm water.
2. Apply cleanser.
3. Gently massage over face.
4. Rinse.
5. Pat dry.
6. Follow with moisturizer.

CeraVe recommends cleansing morning and night and after heavy sweating.



DERMATOLOGIST'S PICK



YES — Core Skinwise Cleanser

If I were building your Skinwise catalogue, I would classify CeraVe Hydrating Cleanser as a **“foundation cleanser”** rather than an active-treatment cleanser.

Its major strength is:

Gentle cleansing for people who don't want their cleanser to fight their skin.



SKINWISE VERDICT

4.7 / 5 

Skinwise Category



Hydrating & Barrier Cleanser

Primary:

Dry • Normal-to-Dry • Sensitive

Secondary:

Normal • Combination • Acne-prone when a gentle non-active cleanser is preferred



SKINWISE WEBSITE DISPLAY

CeraVe Hydrating Cleanser

Gentle Hydrating Cleanser for Normal-to-Dry Skin

- Ceramides + Hyaluronic Acid
- Helps maintain skin moisture
- Fragrance-Free
- Non-Comedogenic

Best for: Dry • Normal-to-Dry • Sensitive Skin

Skinwise Rating: ★ 4.7/5



Where I would place it in your Skinwise range

Cleanser	Skinwise role
CeraVe Hydrating Cleanser	Dry / Normal-to-Dry / Sensitive
CeraVe Foaming Cleanser	Normal / Combination / Oily
CeraVe SA Cleanser	Acne-prone / Rough & Congested

That gives CeraVe a **very logical three-product cleanser family** in Skinwise instead of confusing customers with several similar-looking products.